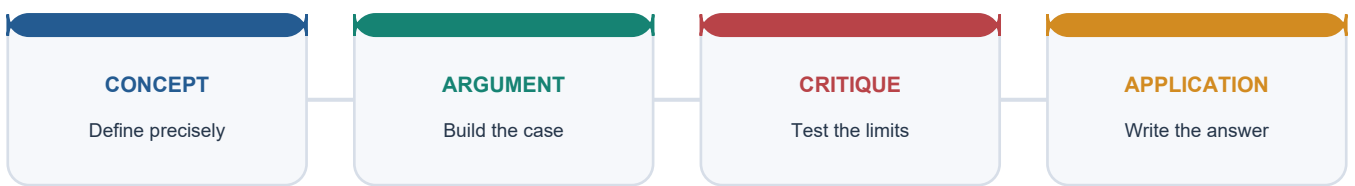


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Kant - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A | 32 diagnostics, 10 solved PYQs and 6 original Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Kant - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone workbook. It reproduces the complete practice apparatus of the Kant learning package and can be attempted without the teaching sessions. Thirty-two original MCQs - twenty-four core diagnostics and eight remedial error-targeting drills - with four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap each; the ten directly owned verified PYQs from 2018 to 2025, each solved in full; and six original Mains models, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. **Syllabus, verbatim:** *Kant: Possibility of Synthetic a priori Judgments; Space and Time; Categories; Ideas of Reason; Antinomies; Critique of Proofs for the Existence of God* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 4. **Discipline:** FACT: marks doctrine on which the standard sources converge, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction for exam use, and CAUTION: marks a live scholarly dispute. Kant is cited by **A/B pagination**. Every model answer is independent learner practice and is never an official UPSC key.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - Possibility of Synthetic a priori Judgments; Space and Time; Categories; Ideas of Reason; Antinomies; Critique of Proofs for the Existence of God - together with the critical project, the transcendental/transcendent discrimination, the change of standpoint, the two expositions, transcendental ideality with empirical reality, the metaphysical and transcendental deductions, apperception, "Understanding makes Nature", the Schematism, the three Analogies, the Refutation of Idealism, phenomena and noumena, the regulative/constitutive distinction, the Paralogisms, the Ideal, the four Antinomies and the dependency chain among the three God-proofs. The eight remedial drills attack the specific confusions that cost marks every year.

MCQ 1. What "transcendental" means in Kant

Consider the following statements about Kant's use of the terms *transcendental* and *transcendent*.

1. A transcendental enquiry concerns the a priori conditions under which objects can be given to us.
2. A transcendent employment of the categories carries them beyond all possible experience.
3. Kant's own philosophy is transcendent, and the errors he diagnoses are transcendental.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct account of transcendental enquiry but attaches Kant's own label to the wrong side, which is exactly the error statement 3 contains.
- **B:** Correct: transcendental concerns conditions of possible experience and is legitimate, while transcendent means crossing beyond experience and is the source of dialectical illusion.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 2 is right, but pairing it with the inversion in statement 3 leaves the candidate calling Kant's method transcendent.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 2 cannot be combined with statement 3, since 3 reverses the very distinction the first two draw.

Examiner trap 1: Using "transcendental" and "transcendent" interchangeably destroys the Dialectic, because Kant's whole diagnosis is that reason slides from the first to the second. Fix the discrimination in your first paragraph and the rest of the script is protected.

MCQ 2. What Hume actually did to Kant, and where Kant says it

Which one of the following statements about Hume's role in the genesis of the critical philosophy is **accurate**?

- A. Kant says in the *Critique of Pure Reason* that Hume awoke him from his dogmatic slumber.
- B. Kant rejects Hume's analysis of experience and shows that necessary connexion is perceived after all.
- C. Kant treats Hume as a dogmatist whose confidence in reason had to be curbed by criticism.
- D. Kant says in the *Prolegomena* that the recollection of Hume interrupted his dogmatic slumber.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the remark belongs to the Preface of the *Prolegomena* of 1783, not to either edition of the *Critique*, and "awoke" is a loose rendering.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant concedes Hume's negative point about experience entirely and relocates necessity to the conditions of objective time-determination instead.
- **C:** Incorrect: Hume is Kant's model of consistent empiricism and the antidote to dogmatism, not an instance of it.
- **D:** Correct: the German verb is *unterbrach*, "interrupted", and the sentence appears in the *Prolegomena* Preface.

Examiner trap 2: Attributing the "dogmatic slumber" sentence to the *Critique* is a visible provenance error. Name the *Prolegomena*, give the year, and mark the translation.

MCQ 3. The analytic/synthetic distinction and the empty cell

Which one of the following is **correct** about Kant's cross-classification of judgements?

- A. Analytic a posteriori judgements cannot exist, since containment makes experience idle.
- B. Synthetic a priori judgements are precisely those whose denial is self-contradictory.
- C. Analytic judgements are ampliative, since they make explicit what was only implicit.
- D. Synthetic a posteriori judgements are strictly universal because they generalise over cases.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: if the predicate is already contained in the subject-concept, analysis alone settles the judgement, so no experience could be required.
- **B:** Incorrect: it is precisely characteristic of a synthetic judgement that its denial involves no contradiction, which is why intuition must be called in.
- **C:** Incorrect: analytic judgements are explicative rather than ampliative; making implicit content explicit adds no new determination.
- **D:** Incorrect: empirical judgements can achieve only comparative universality, since no exception has been met so far.

Examiner trap 3: Naming the empty cell proves that you have understood the classification as a **cross** of two independent distinctions rather than one distinction with four labels. It costs a single clause.

MCQ 4. Kant's two marks of a priori cognition

According to Kant at B3-4, which pair of features marks a cognition as a priori?

- A. Clarity and distinctness of ideas
- B. Simplicity and immediate self-evidence
- C. Necessity and strict universality
- D. Certainty and psychological indubitability

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: clarity and distinctness are Descartes' criteria of truth, and Kant's argument nowhere relies on them.
- **B:** Incorrect: simplicity and self-evidence are marks associated with intuitive first principles in the rationalist tradition, not Kant's tests for apriority.
- **C:** Correct: a judgement is a priori if it is thought together with the impossibility of its being otherwise and admits no possible exception.
- **D:** Incorrect: certainty is psychological and can attach to well-attested empirical beliefs, so it cannot distinguish a priori from a posteriori warrant.

Examiner trap 4: Strict universality is the sharper of the two criteria, because an empirical generalisation may be exceptionless as it happens without being exceptionless by entitlement. Write that sentence and the difference is secured.

MCQ 5. Why " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is synthetic

Kant argues that " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is a synthetic judgement principally because

- A. the concept of the sum of seven and five contains only their union and not twelve
- B. the judgement is verified by counting objects and is therefore drawn from experience
- C. arithmetical propositions can be denied without contradiction and might have been false
- D. the equality sign asserts a real relation between two independently existing quantities

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: to reach twelve one must go beyond the concept and call in intuition, which is precisely what makes the judgement ampliative.
- **B:** Incorrect: counting is the appeal to *pure* intuition, and Kant insists that the result is necessary rather than empirically established.
- **C:** Incorrect: Kant holds arithmetical truths to be necessary; the possibility of denial without contradiction concerns judgement form, not truth-value.
- **D:** Incorrect: this reads the proposition as a claim about existing quantities and abandons the question of the judgement's own warrant.

Examiner trap 5: Candidates who defend the example by saying "we learn it by counting" have converted Kant's showcase of the synthetic **a priori** into an empirical generalisation and lost the point of the section.

MCQ 6. The exact content of the change of standpoint

Which one of the following states Kant's hypothesis at Bxvi-xviii **without distortion**?

- A. Things in themselves conform to the categories of the human understanding.
- B. Objects, as objects of possible experience, conform to our a priori forms.
- C. The human mind creates the objects it perceives entirely out of its own resources.
- D. Cognition must conform to objects, which is why a priori knowledge is impossible.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Kant expressly exempts things in themselves, and extending the claim to them would reinstate the contradiction he is trying to remove.
- **B:** Correct: the restricting clause is part of the hypothesis, not a later qualification added under pressure.
- **C:** Incorrect: what is contributed is form; the matter of sensation is received, and empirical objects are given rather than manufactured.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the assumption Kant proposes to abandon, and he cites its failure as the reason for the experiment.

Examiner trap 6: Quoting the slogan without its restricting clause invites the examiner to read Kant as an idealist about the world itself. The clause is six words long and it is the difference between Kant and the caricature.

MCQ 7. The 2023 printed sentence and Kant's own formulation

The 2023 Paper I question prints: "Precepts without concepts are blind and concepts without precepts are empty." Which one of the following is the **correct** handling of this line?

- A. Silently replace the printed line with Kant's own formulation and answer from that.
- B. Treat the printed line as Kant's own exact words, since it appears in an official paper.
- C. Refuse to answer this part at all, since the quoted sentence misrepresents the *Critique*.
- D. Quote the paper as printed, then give Kant's A51/B75 wording and note the substitution.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: correcting the paper without acknowledgement conceals the discrepancy and forfeits the chance to display textual control.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant's formulation is "Thoughts without content are empty, intuitions without concepts are blind", and "precepts" stands where "intuitions" should stand.
- **C:** Incorrect: the question asked is about the reconciliation of rationalism with empiricism, and that question is perfectly answerable.
- **D:** Correct: quoting as printed, restoring the original and noting the substitution demonstrates accuracy without appearing to lecture the examiner.

Examiner trap 7: The four-step handling - quote, restore, note, answer - is worth marks in itself, and it takes two sentences. Never silently correct an official paper.

MCQ 8. Which arguments of the metaphysical exposition do which job

In the metaphysical exposition of space, which grouping correctly matches the arguments to what they establish?

- A. Arguments 1 and 3 establish apriority; arguments 2 and 4 establish intuitivity.
- B. All four arguments establish apriority, and intuitivity is established separately.
- C. Arguments 1 and 2 establish apriority; arguments 3 and 4 establish intuitivity.
- D. Arguments 2 and 3 establish apriority; arguments 1 and 4 establish intuitivity.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the singularity argument is the third, not the first, and the non-empirical argument is the first, not the third.
- **B:** Incorrect: the exposition assembles its conclusion from both pairs, and the transcendental exposition presupposes rather than supplies intuitivity.
- **C:** Correct: space is not derived from experience and cannot be thought away, which yields apriority; and there is one space whose parts are limitations, given as an infinite magnitude, which yields intuitivity.
- **D:** Incorrect: this scrambles the pairs and leaves the crucial fourth argument attached to the wrong conclusion.

Examiner trap 8: Listing four arguments without sorting them describes the exposition instead of explaining it. Say which pair delivers apriority and which delivers intuition, and the structure of the 2019 answer writes itself.

MCQ 9. The transcendental exposition and its historical qualification

Which one of the following most accurately states the position of Kant's transcendental exposition of space after the rise of non-Euclidean geometry?

- A. Non-Euclidean geometry refutes the claim that space is the a priori form of outer sense.
- B. Non-Euclidean geometry leaves the transcendental exposition of space entirely unaffected.
- C. Non-Euclidean geometry shows that space is after all a discursive concept, not an intuition.
- D. Non-Euclidean geometry weakens the argument from geometry, not the metaphysical exposition.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the general claim that our experience has a priori spatial form is not settled by which geometry describes physical space.
- **B:** Incorrect: the transcendental exposition explicitly leans on the apodictic status of one geometry, so the loss of uniqueness does damage it.
- **C:** Incorrect: the singularity and infinite-givenness arguments turn on features no development in geometry has touched.
- **D:** Correct: the argument from geometry lapses while the metaphysical exposition and the general form-claim survive.

Examiner trap 9: Stating this qualification pre-empts an objection the examiner is likely to have in mind, and it distinguishes the damaged argument from the surviving one instead of conceding everything at once.

MCQ 10. Transcendental ideality with empirical reality

Match Kant's two claims about space with what each of them blocks.

1. Transcendental ideality - 2. Empirical reality

I. It blocks the charge that space is an illusion or a private fancy. II. It blocks both Newton's self-subsistent containers and Leibniz's confused relations among things in themselves.

Which of the following is the correct matching, and what follows?

- A. 1-II, 2-I, and the two claims must always be stated together
- B. 1-I, 2-II, and the two claims must always be stated together
- C. 1-II, 2-I, and the second claim is a later concession
- D. 1-I, 2-II, and the first claim alone captures transcendental idealism

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: ideality denies that space determines things in themselves, which removes both rivals, while empirical reality affirms its objective validity for every appearance.
- **B:** Incorrect: the matching is inverted, since it is ideality and not empirical reality that disposes of Newton and Leibniz.
- **C:** Incorrect: empirical reality is asserted in the Aesthetic itself and is defended again in the Refutation, so it is no concession.
- **D:** Incorrect: quoting ideality alone is precisely what makes Kant look like Berkeley to an examiner.

Examiner trap 10: The commonest single-sentence error in scripts is to quote the ideality and omit the reality. Write the pair as one clause and the Berkeley charge can never be raised against your answer.

MCQ 11. The derivation of the categories

Consider the following statements about Kant's metaphysical deduction.

1. The categories are derived from the logical functions of judgement, on the premise that the understanding is a faculty of judging.
2. The hypothetical form of judgement yields the category of causality and dependence.
3. The third category in each group is an entirely independent concept unrelated to the first two.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it drops the worked example that shows the derivation to be systematic rather than merely asserted.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 3 contradicts Kant's own observation about how the third concept in each group arises.
- **C:** Correct: the derivation rests on the judging premise, and the hypothetical form applied to a manifold given in time becomes the causal rule.
- **D:** Incorrect: Kant notes that totality is plurality as unity, limitation is reality with negation, community is reciprocal causality and necessity is existence given through possibility.

Examiner trap 11: A table reproduced from memory earns very little. Derive one category from its logical form in a single sentence and the whole table becomes an argument.

MCQ 12. Metaphysical deduction versus transcendental deduction

Which one of the following correctly distinguishes the two deductions?

- A. The metaphysical deduction argues from apperception; the transcendental deduction argues from the table of judgements.
- B. The metaphysical deduction identifies the categories; the transcendental deduction justifies their application.
- C. The metaphysical deduction concerns space and time; the transcendental deduction concerns the categories.
- D. The metaphysical deduction is found only in the A edition; the transcendental deduction only in the B edition.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the two methods are exactly reversed, since the table of judgements belongs to the identification and apperception to the justification.
- **B:** Correct: the first answers *quid facti* and the second answers *quid juris*, which is why they cannot be merged.
- **C:** Incorrect: space and time are treated in the Aesthetic, and neither deduction is about the forms of intuition.
- **D:** Incorrect: both chapters appear in both editions, though the Deduction is substantially rewritten at B129-69.

Examiner trap 12: Confusing the two deductions is listed as a standing trap in every Kant guide, and it is easy to avoid with a four-word formula: identification versus justification.

MCQ 13. What the transcendental unity of apperception is

Which one of the following best states Kant's doctrine of apperception?

- A. It is the standing possibility that the "I think" accompany all my representations.
- B. It is the empirical consciousness of oneself obtained by careful inner observation.
- C. It is the simple, permanent soul-substance that the act of thinking is said to reveal.
- D. It is the bundle of perceptions that Hume claimed to discover by careful introspection.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Kant's modal formulation at B131-2 requires only that the "I think" be *able* to accompany them, not that it always does.
- **B:** Incorrect: apperception is not observed at all, since it is the condition of anything being observed as mine.
- **C:** Incorrect: inferring a substance from the formal unity is precisely the paralogism Kant exposes.
- **D:** Incorrect: the bundle is a content found within experience, whereas apperception is a condition of experience.

Examiner trap 13: Dropping the modal phrase "must be able to" converts Kant's claim into the absurd suggestion of a continuous inner commentary. Quote the phrase as Kant writes it.

MCQ 14. "Understanding makes Nature"

Which one of the following is **not** part of what Kant means by the dictum that the understanding makes nature?

- A. Categories supply the a priori rules under which a manifold can count as objective nature.
- B. Nature, formally considered, is the law-governed unity of appearances.
- C. Sensations alone are unordered and must be synthesised to yield objects.
- D. The understanding produces the particular empirical laws that science discovers.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because supplying the a priori rules of objectivity is exactly what the dictum asserts.
- **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because the formal restriction is the doctrine's central qualification.
- **C:** Incorrect as an answer, because the need for synthesis is the premise from which the dictum follows.
- **D:** Correct: particular laws remain empirical discoveries, and Kant secures only the universal form of nature a priori.

Examiner trap 14: The mark is earned by the distinction between universal form and particular law. Without it the dictum sounds like the claim that physics could be done from the armchair.

MCQ 15. Schema and image

Which one of the following correctly states Kant's distinction between a schema and an image?

- A. The schema is a faint mental image, while the image itself is a vivid one.
- B. The schema is a rule of construction, while the image is a particular product.
- C. The schema belongs to sensibility, while the image belongs to the understanding.
- D. The schema is empirical, while the image is pure and given wholly a priori.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: vividness is a difference of degree among images and does not touch the rule-product contrast at all.
- **B:** Correct: any drawn triangle is determinately scalene or equilateral, whereas the schema is the procedure for constructing a triangle in general.
- **C:** Incorrect: images are products of the imagination working in sensibility, and the schema is produced by the same faculty as a rule.
- **D:** Incorrect: transcendental schemata are a priori determinations of time, and it is images that are particular and given.

Examiner trap 15: Writing that "the schema is a mental picture resembling both the category and the appearance" loses the section outright, because it reinstates the very heterogeneity the schema was introduced to bridge.

MCQ 16. Why time and not space supplies the schemata

Kant holds that the mediating schemata must be determinations of time rather than of space because

- A. time is more fundamental than space in the order of Kant's own exposition
- B. spatial relations are less exact and less measurable than temporal relations
- C. time is the form of inner sense and therefore present in every representation
- D. space is empirically real whereas time is transcendently ideal in Kant's system

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: order of exposition is a matter of presentation and could not by itself establish a claim about the conditions of subsumption.
- **B:** Incorrect: exactness is irrelevant, since the requirement is universality of presence rather than precision of measurement.
- **C:** Correct: outer objects are in space, but inner states are not, so only time satisfies the requirement of being contained in every appearance.
- **D:** Incorrect: both space and time are transcendently ideal and empirically real, so this contrast is simply false.

Examiner trap 16: The asymmetry between space and time is stated in the Aesthetic and cashed in the Schematism. Flagging it early and using it later shows architectural understanding rather than recall.

MCQ 17. The three Analogies

Match each Analogy of Experience with the mode of time it determines and the proxy it supplies.

1. First Analogy - 2. Second Analogy - 3. Third Analogy

I. Succession, secured by a causal rule. II. Simultaneity, secured by thoroughgoing reciprocity. III. Duration, secured by a persisting substratum.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

- A. 1-I, 2-II, 3-III
- B. 1-II, 2-III, 3-I
- C. 1-III, 2-I, 3-II
- D. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it assigns succession to the First Analogy, which in fact secures duration through the persistence of substance.
- **B:** Incorrect: it makes the Second Analogy the source of duration and the Third the source of succession, reversing both.
- **C:** Correct: duration requires a persisting substratum, succession requires a causal rule, and simultaneity requires mutual causal community.
- **D:** Incorrect: it correctly places simultaneity third but misassigns duration and succession between the first two.

Examiner trap 17: The three Analogies are not three examples chosen at random; they exhaust the three modes of time, which is why there are exactly three. Say so and the section acquires necessity.

MCQ 18. The house and the ship

In the Second Analogy, what exactly does the contrast between viewing a house and watching a ship drift downstream establish?

- A. That mere succession of perceptions cannot constitute perception of an objective succession
- B. That the perception of a house is instantaneous while the perception of a ship is extended in time
- C. That objective events are perceived more vividly than merely subjective sequences of perception
- D. That the imagination reverses the order of perceptions whenever the object perceived is at rest

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: apprehension is successive in both cases, so the difference between the two must lie in the necessity of the order rather than in succession itself.
- **B:** Incorrect: both apprehensions take time, and Kant's point depends on their both being successive.
- **C:** Incorrect: vividness is a Humean criterion of impressions and plays no role in Kant's argument for objectivity.
- **D:** Incorrect: the reversibility in the house case is a matter of what the perceiver may choose, not of any reversal performed by the imagination.

Examiner trap 18: Using the ship without the house destroys the argument, because it is the **contrast** and not the moving object that shows why a rule is required.

MCQ 19. Strawson's objection and the correct adjudication

Which one of the following states the defensible verdict on Kant's Second Analogy against Hume?

- A. Kant proves the particular causal laws that Hume had declared to be unknowable.
- B. Kant secures entitlement to the concept of cause but leaves causal laws empirical.
- C. Kant fails entirely, since Strawson shows the whole argument to be a non-sequitur.
- D. Kant relocates necessity into the objects, where Hume had simply failed to find it.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Kant never claimed to derive particular laws, and doing so would contradict his own separation of form from content.
- **B:** Correct: the concept of cause is shown not to be a bastard of the imagination, while which causes operate remains a matter for science.
- **C:** Incorrect: Strawson's charge targets the step from determined order of apprehension to causal necessitation, not the whole enterprise, and Allison offers a reply.
- **D:** Incorrect: necessity is located in the conditions of objective time-determination, not in perceived objects.

Examiner trap 19: "Kant answered Hume" is a slogan until you say **how much** of Hume's demand was met. The entitlement-versus-particular-laws sentence is the single most transferable line in this topic.

MCQ 20. The negative noumenon

Which one of the following correctly describes Kant's noumenon in the negative sense?

- A. An object of a non-sensible intellectual intuition available to all finite minds
- B. A hidden object that causes our sensations while itself remaining unobserved
- C. An illusory appearance that empirical criteria eventually expose as deceptive
- D. A limiting concept marking where sensible intuition ceases to yield knowledge

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: that describes the *positive* noumenon, and Kant denies that human beings possess intellectual intuition.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is Jacobi's objection about noumenal affection, and asserting it as Kant's own doctrine is the commonest Kant error in scripts.
- **C:** Incorrect: illusion is distinguished from reality *within* the field of appearances by empirical criteria, and has nothing to do with the noumenon.
- **D:** Correct: the negative noumenon is a *Grenzbegriff* whose whole function is to forbid the extension of the categories beyond experience.

Examiner trap 20: The noumenon marks the edge of the screen, not a second object behind it. Open with appearance-is-not-illusion and the whole subtopic stays clean.

MCQ 21. Regulative and constitutive uses of the Ideas

Consider the following statements about the three Ideas of Reason.

1. The Ideas of soul, world and God correspond to the categorical, hypothetical and disjunctive relations respectively.
2. Used regulatively, the Ideas direct enquiry toward systematic unity and are legitimate.
3. Used constitutively, the Ideas yield theoretical knowledge of a soul-substance, a world-totality and God.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the constitutive use is precisely what Kant denies, since it is the source of the Paralogisms, Antinomies and failed proofs.
- **B:** Correct: the Ideas are derived from the three relations and are indispensable as maxims of systematic enquiry.
- **C:** Incorrect: it correctly affirms the regulative use but then grants exactly the constitutive employment the Dialectic refutes.
- **D:** Incorrect: it pairs a correct derivation with the illegitimate constitutive claim and omits the regulative employment altogether.

Examiner trap 21: Writing that the Ideas are "useless fictions" is as wrong as treating them as objects. They are perfectly good instructions and perfectly bad objects, and both halves earn marks.

MCQ 22. The fallacy in the Paralogisms

The Paralogisms of rational psychology are fallacious, according to Kant, because they

- A. rely on premises drawn from experience that turn out on inspection to be false
- B. presuppose the very conclusion about the soul that they had set out to prove
- C. equivocate between the "I" as logical subject and the "I" as a real object
- D. infer a universal conclusion from an insufficient number of observed instances

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the premises are not empirical at all, which is what makes rational psychology a purely a priori discipline.
- **B:** Incorrect: circularity is a different fault, and Kant's charge is specifically that the middle term shifts its sense.
- **C:** Correct: from the fact that I must think of myself as the subject of my thoughts, nothing follows about what I am.
- **D:** Incorrect: hasty generalisation is an inductive fault, whereas a paralogism is a formal error in a syllogism.

Examiner trap 22: Using the word "paralogism" without naming the fallacy is decoration. Say **equivocation**, identify the shifting term, and the answer becomes diagnostic.

MCQ 23. When reason enters antinomy, and how the four divide

Which one of the following is **correct** about the Antinomies?

- A. Pure reason enters antinomy when it treats the world-series as an object in itself, and the mathematical antinomies have both sides false.
- B. Pure reason enters antinomy whenever it applies the categories to appearances, and all four antinomies receive exactly the same resolution.
- C. Pure reason enters antinomy because the phenomena-noumena distinction mechanically generates contradiction, and both sides are always true.
- D. Pure reason enters antinomy when the understanding oversteps sensibility, and the dynamical antinomies are resolved by declaring both sides false.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the demand for the unconditioned becomes antinomial when read constitutively, and the world-whole, never being given as complete, is neither finite nor infinite.
- **B:** Incorrect: applying the categories to appearances is their legitimate employment, and the two classes receive different resolutions.
- **C:** Incorrect: the distinction is the cure rather than the cause, since it is transcendental realism about appearances that generates the conflict.
- **D:** Incorrect: it misidentifies the faculty at fault and attaches the mathematical verdict to the dynamical pair.

Examiner trap 23: Giving one resolution for all four antinomies is the commonest structural error at 20 marks. Mathematical: both false. Dynamical: both may be true. Say why - homogeneous versus heterogeneous series.

MCQ 24. The dependency among the three God-proofs

Which one of the following correctly states Kant's structural claim about the speculative proofs?

- A. Each of the three proofs stands or falls entirely on the strength of its own evidence.
- B. The ontological proof depends on the cosmological, which depends on the design proof.
- C. The design proof succeeds in establishing an omnipotent creator from the order of nature.
- D. The design proof needs the cosmological, which needs the ontological, so all fail.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: independence is exactly what Kant denies, and denying it is what allows a single refutation to be decisive.
- **B:** Incorrect: the dependency runs in the opposite direction, since the ontological proof is the terminus rather than the starting point.
- **C:** Incorrect: Kant grants at most an architect who orders pre-existing material, since a finite effect licenses only a proportionate cause.
- **D:** Correct: design must borrow an infinite or necessary cause, and the cosmological proof must identify its necessary being with the most real being.

Examiner trap 24: Treating the three proofs as three separate exercises doubles the length of your answer and halves its force. State the dependency chain in one sentence and refute once.

MCQ 25. Remedial - what Kant does and does not prove about God

A candidate writes: "Kant's critique of the three proofs establishes that God does not exist." What is wrong with this?

- A. Nothing at all; Kant is an atheist and says so in the second-edition Preface.
- B. Kant establishes that God exists, but only by way of the design argument.
- C. Kant establishes that the very concept of God's existence is self-contradictory.
- D. Kant establishes only that God's existence cannot be demonstrated theoretically.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the second-edition Preface says the opposite - knowledge was denied in order to make room for rational belief.
- **B:** Incorrect: the design argument is the one Kant treats most respectfully and still finds unable to reach an infinite creator.
- **C:** Incorrect: Kant argues that denying God's existence involves no contradiction, which is a claim about logic, not about God's impossibility.
- **D:** Correct: the position is theoretical agnosticism combined with a practical postulate, never atheism.

Examiner trap 25: The sentence "Kant is theoretically agnostic, not atheistic" costs six words and prevents an examiner from reading your whole answer as a misunderstanding.

MCQ 26. Remedial - noumena and Plato's Forms

Why is it wrong to gloss Kant's noumena as equivalent to Plato's Forms?

- A. Plato's Forms are sensible particulars, whereas noumena are universals.
- B. Plato's Forms are knowable by reason, whereas noumena are precisely unknowable.
- C. Plato's Forms are unknowable, whereas noumena are known through pure intuition.
- D. Plato's Forms exist in time, whereas noumena exist outside space only.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Forms are not sensible particulars on any reading, and the contrast misdescribes both doctrines.
- **B:** Correct: the resemblance is only that both lie beyond sense, and the epistemic verdicts on them are exactly opposite.
- **C:** Incorrect: this inverts both positions, since Kant denies that we possess the intellectual intuition such knowledge would require.
- **D:** Incorrect: Kant's point is not a location claim, and describing noumena as existing "outside space only" reintroduces the second-object picture.

Examiner trap 26: Superficial resemblances between traditions are attractive and expensive. If you draw the comparison at all, draw it in order to mark the difference.

MCQ 27. Remedial - the Refutation of Idealism and the "scandal" footnote

Which one of the following is correct about the Refutation of Idealism?

- A. It was added in the second edition of 1787, and the "scandal" remark is a Preface note.
- B. It appeared in the first edition of 1781, and the "scandal" remark is in the Refutation.
- C. It was added in 1787 and is directed principally against Berkeley's own dogmatic idealism.
- D. It appeared in 1781 and proves the existence of things in themselves outside us in space.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the Refutation occupies B274-9 and the remark stands at Bxxxix note, in the Preface rather than in the proof.
- **B:** Incorrect: both claims are wrong, since the section is B-only and the remark is a Preface footnote.
- **C:** Incorrect: Berkeley is answered by the Transcendental Aesthetic, while the Refutation proper is directed at Descartes.
- **D:** Incorrect: the objects proved are empirically external appearances in space, not things in themselves.

Examiner trap 27: Edition-specific material is a cheap source of visible error. The Refutation and the B-Deduction are B-only; the original Fourth Paralogism is A-only.

MCQ 28. Remedial - the two resolutions must not be merged

A candidate resolves all four antinomies by saying that thesis and antithesis are true in different realms. Where does this go wrong?

- A. It is correct for all four, since every antinomy turns on the phenomena-noumena distinction.
- B. It is wrong for all four, since Kant declares both sides false in every one of the cases.
- C. It is correct only for the dynamical antinomies; the mathematical antinomies have both sides false.
- D. It is correct only for the mathematical antinomies; the dynamical antinomies have both sides false.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the mathematical antinomies concern a homogeneous series, where no second standpoint is available to divide the claims between.
- **B:** Incorrect: the third antinomy's resolution is precisely that natural determination and spontaneous causality can both hold, of different standpoints.
- **C:** Correct: heterogeneity of the series in the dynamical pair permits compatibility, while the world-whole in the mathematical pair is simply no object.
- **D:** Incorrect: this reverses the two verdicts and would leave freedom excluded by the very resolution meant to make room for it.

Examiner trap 28: The classification is not decoration; it *determines* the resolution. State the reason - homogeneous versus heterogeneous conditions - and the two verdicts stop looking arbitrary.

MCQ 29. Remedial - substance, alteration and coming-to-be

According to the First Analogy, what is the correct description of change in the world of appearances?

- A. Substances come into being and pass away, and this is what change means.
- B. Change is an illusion, since the persistence of substance excludes all alteration.
- C. Substance persists, and what we call change is the alteration of its states.
- D. Both substance and its states persist, and only our perceptions alter.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: coming-to-be and passing-away of substance is exactly what the Analogy denies, since time-determination would then have no proxy.
- **B:** Incorrect: alteration is affirmed, not denied; it is precisely the changing of determinations against a persisting bearer.
- **C:** Correct: what changes are accidents, and substance does not change but *has* changing states.
- **D:** Incorrect: making the alteration merely perceptual would collapse the objective/subjective distinction the Analogies exist to ground.

Examiner trap 29: The distinction between *alteration* of states and *coming-to-be* of substance is the whole content of the First Analogy. Losing it turns Kant's argument into a bare assertion that things last.

MCQ 30. Remedial - the "Copernican" analogy

A candidate writes that Kant's Copernican revolution places the human being at the centre of the universe. What is the correct correction?

- A. Kant does place the knower at the centre, but only within the practical philosophy.
- B. Kant uses the phrase "Copernican revolution" himself at Bxvi, so the reading is authorised.
- C. The analogy concerns the centre of the solar system, which Kant relocates to the mind.
- D. Copernicus displaced the earth from the centre; the analogy is about explanation.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the practical philosophy is not in view at Bxvi, and importing it compounds the original confusion.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant invokes Copernicus but the label "Copernican revolution" is the commentators', not Kant's self-description.
- **C:** Incorrect: no centre is being relocated at all, since the comparison is about how apparent phenomena are explained.
- **D:** Correct: Copernicus explained apparent celestial motion by moving the observer, and Kant explains a priori knowledge by the constitution of the knower.

Examiner trap 30: The popular reading inverts the very comparison it claims to use. One clause about the direction of explanation removes the error and displays the provenance caution at the same time.

MCQ 31. Remedial - what the Third Antinomy establishes about freedom

Which one of the following states what Kant's resolution of the Third Antinomy actually achieves?

- A. It proves that human beings actually possess transcendental freedom.
- B. It shows that freedom is thinkable without contradiction alongside determinism.
- C. It refutes natural determinism as it operates in the phenomenal world.
- D. It establishes that freedom and natural causality are two names for one relation.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a theoretical proof of freedom is exactly what Kant denies is available to speculative reason.
- **B:** Correct: the antithesis holds of appearances while spontaneous causality remains conceivable of the same agent considered as noumenon.
- **C:** Incorrect: Kant reaffirms the Second Analogy for appearances and does not weaken it in the slightest.
- **D:** Incorrect: identifying them would dissolve the distinction of standpoints on which the whole resolution depends.

Examiner trap 31: "Room, not proof" is the four-word formula. Writing that Kant proves freedom converts a careful resolution into an over-claim the examiner will notice immediately.

MCQ 32. Remedial - the owner boundary in a God-proof answer

In answering a question on Kant's critique of the proofs for God's existence, which one of the following is the correct treatment of Kant's moral philosophy?

- A. Confine it to the practical postulate of God, and do not expand into ethics.
- B. Devote a full section to the categorical imperative, since morality grounds Kant's theism.
- C. Omit all reference to practical reason, since only theoretical reason is printed in the clause.
- D. Replace the theoretical critique with the moral argument, which Kant regarded as decisive.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the owner permits the practical postulate as a bounded consequence of the failure of speculative proof, and no further.
- **B:** Incorrect: the categorical imperative, the good will and autonomy are Kantian ethics and are not printed in this syllabus item.
- **C:** Incorrect: omitting the postulate loses Kant's own positive doctrine and leaves the answer looking like a bare negation.
- **D:** Incorrect: the question asks about the critique of the speculative proofs, and replacing it answers a different question.

Examiner trap 32: Two sentences on the postulate, then stop. A God-proof answer that becomes an ethics survey has left the printed clause, and length will not compensate for scope.

Answer key, in order: B · D · A · C · A · B · D · C · D · A · C · B · A · D · B · C · C · A · B · D · B · C · A · D · D · B · A · C · C · D · B · A

Placement audit: A appears 8 times, B 8 times, C 8 times and D 8 times. There is no ABCD rotation window anywhere in the sequence, there are three adjacent repeats (positions 16-17, 24-25 and 28-29) and no run of three identical keys.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers; the 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I texts are all held locally in books\philosophy_optional\ and the English wording of every Kant part below was read directly from those PDFs. Where the OCR of a mark column was unreliable, the mark value follows the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger and is flagged. Doctrinal claims are attributed by **A/B pagination**, and interpretive disputes - whether transcendental idealism is a two-world or a two-aspect doctrine, whether the A- and B-Deductions argue differently, whether Kant's refutation reaches modal versions of the ontological argument - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage: ten directly owned Kant PYQs from 2018 to 2025 - every part the ledger routes to this syllabus item - and six original solved Mains models, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. **ANALYSIS: Corpus signal:** Kant owns 10 of 112 Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, and **2025 is the only year without a Kant-owned part**. Four further parts *name* Kant but are owned elsewhere - 2018 Q2(c) and the Quine parts (Topic 11), 2020 Q2(a) and 2025 Q2(c) (Topic 03), and 2025 Q1(e) (Topic 05) - and in each of those the owner's argument must be completed **before** Kant's reply is reported.

Citation discipline used in every answer. Kant is cited by A/B pagination: Bxvi-xviii (the change of standpoint), Bxxx ("deny knowledge... make room for faith"), Bxxxix n. ("scandal of philosophy"), B1 and B3-4 (the a priori and its marks), A51/B75 (empty thoughts, blind intuitions), B131-2 (the "I think"), A137-47/B176-87 (Schematism), A141/B180-1 ("an art concealed..."), A176/B219 and A183/B226 ("time itself cannot be perceived"), B218 (general principle of the Analogies), B224, A189-93/B232-8, B256 (the three Analogies), B274-9 (Refutation of Idealism), A598/B626 ("being is not a real predicate"). The *Prolegomena* (1783) is cited separately for Hume's interruption.

2018 · Q2(b) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the significance of the Kantian dictum, 'Understanding makes Nature'. How far do you agree that Hegel's Absolutism is the culmination of the Kantian Dualism? Discuss. Give reasons in favour of your answer.

ANALYSIS: Marks note: the local 2018 Paper I PDF renders the mark column unreliably; the 15-mark value follows the repository's verified PYQ ledger.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two limbs - "explain the significance", then "how far do you agree... give reasons"
Core issue	In what sense the understanding constitutes nature, and whether Hegel completes or overturns Kant
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the dictum with its restriction, three Hegelian moves, one ruling with reasons
Ideal thesis	Nature <i>formally</i> considered is constituted by the categories; Hegel radicalises constitutive idealism and simultaneously attempts to overcome Kant's limits
Non-negotiables	Form versus matter; universal law versus particular law; the three Hegelian moves; a distinction rather than a flat yes or no

Independent model answer

The dictum. The understanding "makes" nature **formally considered** - as the law-governed unity of appearances. Sensations alone are unordered; synthesis under the categories of substance, causality and community yields objects standing in objective temporal relations, and hence universal laws. Since the conditions of possible experience are also the conditions of the objects of experience, experienced nature necessarily conforms to them.

Its significance is threefold. It explains how the fundamental principles of natural science can be synthetic and yet a priori, since their necessity is contributed rather than discovered. It answers Hume without denying his analysis of impressions. And it fixes the limit precisely: what is constituted is form, not matter.

Three denials protect the claim. The understanding does not create the sensory manifold, which is received; it does not produce particular empirical laws, which remain empirical discoveries won by observation; and the constitution is transcendental and therefore public, not private imagination. Transcendental idealism is in this sense empirical realism.

Hegel. He accepts that thought is constitutive rather than a passive copy of a ready-made reality. He radicalises this by treating the categories as internally self-developing and contradiction as the motor of thought rather than a symptom of illegitimate transcendence. He rejects Kant's fixed oppositions - sensibility and understanding, phenomenon and noumenon, finite and unconditioned - and above all the unknowable thing in itself.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Partially. Hegel is a culmination in extending constitutive idealism, but an attempted **overcoming** in rejecting Kant's limits. The gain is systematic unity; the cost is the stronger claim that dialectical reason knows the Absolute.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q2(b): the question has two limbs and a directive demanding reasons. A script that explains the dictum beautifully and then reports Hegel neutrally has answered one and a half questions.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: dictum in four lines; significance in three; denials in three; Hegel in three; ruling in two.

- **Structure:** doctrine -> significance -> denials -> Hegel's three moves -> distinguished verdict.
- **Doctrine:** categories as rules of objectivity; form versus matter; universal versus particular law.

- **Evidence:** the supreme principle that conditions of experience are conditions of its objects; the three Hegelian moves.
- **Distinction:** culmination in one sense, overcoming in another.
- **Criticism:** note that Hegel's gain in unity is bought by a claim Kant would call transcendent.

2019 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: How does Kant argue for the transcendence of Space and Time? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does Kant argue" - reconstruct the argument , not the conclusion
Core issue	The a priori and intuitive status of space and time, and what it explains
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the wording caution, both expositions, the two rivals, the double result, one qualification
Ideal thesis	Two expositions with different jobs establish that space and time are pure forms of intuition, transcendentally ideal and empirically real
Non-negotiables	"Transcendence" read correctly; four metaphysical arguments sorted into two pairs; geometry and arithmetic; Newton and Leibniz; ideality with reality

Independent model answer

ANALYSIS: A word first. "Transcendence" here cannot mean existence beyond experience - that would be the *transcendent* error Kant attacks. It means the **a priori and transcendentally ideal** status of space and time, established by two expositions with different jobs.

Metaphysical exposition. Space is not derived from experience: to refer sensations to something outside me, or to represent things as beside one another, space must already be presupposed, so it is the condition and not the product of outer experience. Space is necessary: we may think it empty of objects but cannot think it away, whereas objects can always be thought away. These two arguments establish **apriority**.

Space is singular: there is only one space, and particular spaces are limitations within it, whereas a general concept has instances *under* it rather than parts *in* it. Space is given as an **infinite magnitude**: a concept may contain infinitely many representations under it, but no concept contains infinitely many within it. These two establish **intuitivity**. Space is therefore a *pure intuition*. Parallel arguments hold for time - succession and simultaneity presuppose it and cannot yield it; times are parts of one time; it is given as unlimited.

Transcendental exposition. This shows what the representation explains. Space grounds **geometry**: figures are constructed in pure intuition, so what is proved of the construction holds necessarily of every object of outer sense, since such objects can be given only under this form. Time grounds **arithmetic** and the pure doctrine of motion, since number is successive addition and alteration is possible only in time.

The two rivals fail. Newton's self-subsistent containers are two eternal non-entities that no experience could disclose and yet condition everything real. Leibniz's confused relations among things in themselves could never be known with necessity, so apodictic geometry would be lost. Both treat space as something *encountered*; Kant makes it the form of encounter.

Result. Transcendental **ideality** with empirical **reality**: nothing at all apart from our sensibility, yet objectively valid of every appearance without exception.

Verdict. **ANALYSIS:** The argument from geometry lapsed once geometry ceased to be uniquely Euclidean; the metaphysical exposition, and Kant's dissolution of the Newton-Leibniz dispute, survive intact.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q4(a): the first line must neutralise the word "transcendence". Everything after that is structure.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: caution in two lines; four metaphysical arguments in six; transcendental exposition in four; rivals in three; result in two; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** wording caution -> metaphysical exposition sorted into two pairs -> transcendental exposition -> rivals -> double result -> qualification.
- **Doctrine:** forms of outer and inner sense; pure intuition; ideality and reality.
- **Evidence:** the four arguments; geometry and arithmetic as the explananda.
- **Distinction:** apriority established by arguments 1-2, intuitivity by 3-4.
- **Criticism:** non-Euclidean geometry damages the transcendental exposition, not the metaphysical one.

2020 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: When does Pure Reason enter into the realm of Antinomies according to Kant? Is Kant's notion of Antinomies of Pure Reason a natural culmination of his distinction between Phenomena and Noumena? Give reasons in favour of your answer.

ANALYSIS: Marks note: the local 2020 Paper I PDF renders the mark column unreliably; the 15-mark value follows the repository's verified PYQ ledger.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	A "when" question, then a yes/no with reasons
Core issue	The trigger of antinomy, and whether the phenomena/noumena distinction causes or cures it
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the trigger, one example of the construction, the ruling, two reasons
Ideal thesis	Reason enters antinomy when the regulative demand for the unconditioned is read constitutively; the antinomies culminate transcendental realism about appearances , not Kant's distinction
Non-negotiables	"Given whole" as the shared false premise; the two resolutions; the corrected formulation of the second limb

Independent model answer

When. Pure reason enters antinomy when its legitimate search for conditions demands an **absolutely unconditioned, completed world-series** and then treats that totality as an object given in itself. Reason's principle - if the conditioned is given, the whole series of conditions is given - is a *maxim* of enquiry; read as a statement about an existing object, it generates conflict.

How the conflict is built. Each antinomy proves thesis and antithesis indirectly. Suppose the world has no beginning: an infinite series would already have been completed, which is impossible. Suppose it has a beginning: before it lay empty time, in which nothing can begin, since no part of empty time distinguishes existence from non-existence. Both proofs assume the world is a **given whole** of which one predicate must hold.

The ruling. ANALYSIS: **No - not a culmination of the phenomena/noumena distinction.** The antinomies are the natural culmination of **transcendental realism about appearances**: they arise from *ignoring* the boundary, not from maintaining it.

Two reasons. First, the distinction is the **cure**. Once appearances are not things in themselves, the world-series is given only as a regress that may always be continued, so the mathematical antinomies dissolve with both sides false and the shared premise is exposed. Second, the distinction is what permits the dynamical resolution: natural determination holds of appearances while spontaneous causality remains thinkable of the same agent considered as noumenon.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Reason enters antinomy by hypostatizing a regulative demand; Kant's dualism resolves the conflict rather than producing it - and the antinomies thereby function as an indirect proof of transcendental idealism.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q3(c): the second limb invites an agreement that would invert Kant. Ruling first, then two independent reasons.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: trigger in four lines; construction in five; ruling in two; reasons in four; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** trigger -> construction with one worked pair -> ruling -> two reasons -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** regulative versus constitutive; the given whole; the two resolutions.
- **Evidence:** the first antinomy's double *reductio*.
- **Distinction:** transcendental realism about appearances versus the phenomena/noumena boundary.
- **Criticism:** note the indirect-proof status, which is a strength and not a mere by-product.

2021 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain how Cartesian formulation of ontological argument is criticised by Kant.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Explain how" - exposition dominates, but the mechanism must be exhibited
Core issue	Why no analysis of a concept can yield existence
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: Descartes' version, the refutation, the thalers, the contradiction corollary
Ideal thesis	Existence posits rather than determines, so it cannot be one of the perfections contained in a concept
Non-negotiables	"Real predicate" glossed correctly; A598/B626; the thaler example used for the right point

Independent model answer

The Cartesian argument. God is the most perfect, most real being. Existence is a perfection. A being lacking existence would lack a perfection and so would not be the most perfect being. Therefore God necessarily exists. Descartes' image is that existence belongs to God's essence as three angles belong to a triangle.

Kant's refutation. "Being is obviously not a real predicate" (A598/B626). ANALYSIS: *Real* here means **content-adding**, from *res* - a *Bestimmung*, a determination that enlarges a concept. It does not mean "concerning a real thing".

To say that something exists is not to add a property to its concept; it is to **posit** the concept's object, with all its predicates, as actual. Hence the thalers: "a hundred real thalers do not contain the least coin more than a hundred possible thalers." The concept is identical whether or not any thalers exist; what differs is my financial position, not my thought.

It follows that "existence" cannot appear among the perfections in the concept of God. The argument moves entirely inside the concept and never reaches outside it. However rich the concept, it determines only what God would be *if* God exists.

The corollary about contradiction. Descartes needs the denial to be self-contradictory. Kant answers that if we reject subject and predicate together - if there is no such being at all - nothing remains that could conflict. Contradiction arises only when a subject is retained and one of its genuine predicates denied, and existence is not that kind of predicate.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Kant does not show God's non-existence; he shows that no concept, however perfect, can contain its own instantiation.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q2(c): "Explain how" rewards mechanism. The gloss on "real predicate" is where most scripts silently go wrong.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: argument in four lines; refutation in six; thalers in three; corollary in four; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** Descartes' version -> the refutation -> the illustration -> the corollary -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** positing versus determining; *Bestimmung*.
- **Evidence:** A598/B626; the hundred thalers.
- **Distinction:** what a concept fixes versus whether anything answers to it.
- **Criticism:** the verdict marks the limit - non-provability, not non-existence.

2022 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

Question: What is apperception, according to Immanuel Kant? Discuss with reference to his transcendental exposition of space and time.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Definition, then an explicit link to a <i>named</i> doctrine
Core issue	What apperception is, and how it stands to the forms of intuition
Scope boundary	Ten marks: definition, three negations, the architecture, one caution
Ideal thesis	Apperception is the formal condition that the "I think" can accompany all my representations; it unifies what sensibility supplies
Non-negotiables	The modal "must be able to"; function not substance; the architecture stated in the right order

Independent model answer

Definition. The transcendental unity of apperception is the formal condition that the representation "I think" (*Ich denke*) **must be able to** accompany all my representations (B131-2); otherwise something would be represented in me that could not be thought, and would be nothing *for me*.

What it is not. It is not an empirical self found by introspection - not Hume's bundle. It is not a soul-substance; inferring one is the Paralogism. It is *transcendental*, a condition of possibility, not *transcendent*.

Relation to space and time. Space and time supply the pure forms **in** which a manifold can be given; apperception supplies the requirement that this manifold be **combinable in one self-consciousness**; the categories are the rules of synthesis by which a manifold given in space and time is represented as an object for one "I think".

ANALYSIS: The necessary caution. The transcendental exposition does **not** itself deduce apperception. The architecture runs: the Aesthetic supplies the forms of intuition, the Deduction justifies the categories through apperceptive unity, the Schematism mediates their temporal application.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Apperception unifies what sensibility gives; it neither creates the sensible matter nor proves a soul.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2022 Q1(e): the examiner has named a doctrine, so the link must be explicit and correctly ordered. Reversing the architecture is the standard failure.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: definition in three lines; negations in three; architecture in four; caution in three; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** definition -> negations -> architecture -> caution -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** original apperception; synthesis; transcendental versus transcendent.
- **Evidence:** B131-2 and the modal formulation.
- **Distinction:** condition of experience versus content within it.
- **Criticism:** the caution is itself the assessment, and it is what a ten-mark part can afford.

2022 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: How does Kant construct antinomies to illustrate the illusory tendencies of pure reason? Explain and examine the antinomies presented by Kant.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three limbs - construct, explain, examine ; the examination carries the marks
Core issue	The mechanism of construction, the four pairs, and the two resolutions
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: illusion, construction, four pairs stated compactly, classification, both resolutions, assessment
Ideal thesis	The antinomies expose a shared false premise and thereby serve as an indirect proof of transcendental idealism
Non-negotiables	Both proofs by <i>reductio</i> ; mathematical both false, dynamical both may be true; freedom is room, not proof

Independent model answer

Illusion first. Reason seeks the unconditioned, and the search is legitimate as a maxim of enquiry. Transcendental illusion is **natural and unavoidable**: criticism prevents deception but never dispels the appearance, as the moon still looks larger on the horizon to one who knows why.

Construction. Kant selects one cosmological Idea per category-group, applied to the world-series. Each side is proved **indirectly**, by *reductio* of its opposite, and both proofs are given their full force rather than caricatured. Both share one premise: that the world is a **given, completed whole** of which one of two contradictory predicates must hold. The conflict is therefore necessary, not careless - which is what makes it an argument against the premise rather than against either party.

The four pairs. First: the world has a beginning in time and limits in space - against: it is infinite in both. Second: composites consist of simple parts - against: nothing simple exists. Third: there is causality through freedom besides natural causality - against: everything happens by natural law alone. Fourth: an absolutely necessary being belongs to the world - against: no such being exists.

Classification. The first two are **mathematical**: the series is homogeneous, its members being of the same kind as the conditioned. The last two are **dynamical**: the condition need not be sensible at all.

The two resolutions. Mathematical: **both sides are false**. The world-whole is never given as complete, so it is neither finite nor infinite; the regress may always be continued. Dynamical: **both may be true**. Natural determination holds of appearances, while spontaneous causality remains thinkable of the same agent considered as noumenon; and no necessary being need occur within the series, though an intelligible ground is not thereby contradicted.

Examination. ANALYSIS: Freedom is made **thinkable**, not proved: theoretical reason establishes only that spontaneous causality involves no contradiction. The antinomies show that speculative metaphysics of the supersensible cannot be a science, and they motivate the confinement of knowledge to phenomena. Above all they function as an **indirect proof** of transcendental idealism: realism about appearances generates the contradictions and idealism dissolves them, so a doctrine argued analytically earlier is here vindicated by its explanatory yield.

Verdict. CAUTION: Powerful but not decisive - the proof works only if no third diagnosis exists, and Hegel offers one: contradiction as productive rather than pathological.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2022 Q3(a): "examine" is the marked limb. A list of four antinomies without resolutions answers a different question.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: illusion in two lines; construction in five; pairs in five; classification in three; resolutions in five; examination in four; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** illusion -> construction -> four pairs -> classification -> two resolutions -> examination -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** regulative versus constitutive; homogeneous versus heterogeneous series.
- **Evidence:** the double *reductio*; the shared premise.
- **Distinction:** both false versus both may be true.
- **Criticism:** the indirect proof with its stated limit.

2023 · Q1(a) · 10 marks

Question: "Precepts without concepts are blind and concepts without precepts are empty." In the light of this statement discuss how Kant reconciles rationalism with empiricism.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"In the light of this statement... discuss" - locate the sentence, then use it
Core issue	The reconciliation, exhibited through the quoted formula
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the wording note, both halves, the two stems, one closing restriction
Ideal thesis	Content from sensibility and form from understanding - a division of labour, not a compromise
Non-negotiables	Quote as printed, restore A51/B75, note the substitution, then answer

Independent model answer

ANALYSIS: Wording note. The paper prints "Precepts" twice. Kant's own formulation is: "Thoughts without content are empty, intuitions without concepts are blind" (A51/B75). "Precepts" stands where "intuitions" should stand, and the halves are transposed. The point of the sentence is unaffected.

The two halves. *Thoughts without content are empty* corrects **rationalism**: a concept for which no corresponding intuition is even possible determines no object. *Intuitions without concepts are blind* corrects **empiricism**: an unsynthesised manifold is not yet perception of an *object*, since without a rule there is nothing to be right or wrong about.

The reconciliation. Human cognition has **two stems**: sensibility, receptive, supplying content under the forms of space and time, and understanding, spontaneous, supplying rules through the categories. "The understanding can intuit nothing, and the senses can think nothing." Knowledge is their union.

This is not a fifty-fifty compromise. Kant sides with the empiricist about the **source of content** and with the rationalist about the **source of necessity**, which is possible only because he has separated the two questions.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The reconciliation is bought by restricting the categories to possible experience - so it is simultaneously an anti-metaphysical verdict.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2023 Q1(a): handle the printed wording in two sentences, then answer the question actually asked. Never silently correct the paper.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: wording note in three lines; two halves in four; reconciliation in four; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** wording note -> both halves -> two stems -> the non-compromise -> restriction.
- **Doctrine:** receptivity and spontaneity; A51/B75.
- **Evidence:** the quoted formula and the "can intuit nothing" sentence.
- **Distinction:** content versus necessity, separated in Session 2.
- **Criticism:** the closing restriction turns a summary into an argument.

2023 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

Question: What are the main arguments offered by Kant to prove that apriori synthetic judgements are possible? Discuss with examples.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Main arguments... with examples" - plural, and each example must be argued
Core issue	Why each showcase is both synthetic and a priori, and how the possibility is explained
Scope boundary	Ten marks: three domains, one line of argument each, then the explanation
Ideal thesis	Kant exhibits instances and then explains their possibility by the conformity of objects to our forms
Non-negotiables	The reason each case is synthetic; the reason each is a priori; the Copernican explanation

Independent model answer

Kant does not postulate the class; he exhibits instances and then asks how they are possible.

Arithmetic. " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is **synthetic**: the concept of the sum contains only the thought of uniting the two numbers, not twelve, which must be brought in by counting in pure intuition. It is **a priori**: no experiment could falsify it and it admits no exception.

Geometry. "The straight line between two points is the shortest" is **synthetic**: "straight" is a quality, "shortest" a quantity, and no analysis of the first yields the second. It is **a priori**: it is constructed in pure spatial intuition.

Fundamental natural science. "Every event has a cause" is **synthetic**: the concept of something that begins to be does not contain a determining antecedent. It is **a priori**: it cannot be induced without circularity, since objective time-order presupposes it.

How they are possible. Because objects, *as objects of possible experience*, conform to our a priori forms - space, time and the categories - what those forms contribute is necessarily valid of everything that can appear.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Metaphysics *aspires* to this class and fails, which is why the argument that vindicates mathematics closes speculative theology.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2023 Q1(e): each example needs two clauses - why synthetic, why a priori. Listing examples without arguing them answers half the question.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: one line of framing; three examples in nine; explanation in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** framing -> three worked examples -> the Copernican explanation -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** ampliative versus explicative; necessity and strict universality.
- **Evidence:** the three showcases, each with its argument.
- **Distinction:** metaphysics aspires to the class and fails.
- **Criticism:** the honest note about non-Euclidean geometry.

2024 · Q1(b) · 10 marks

Question: How does Kant respond to Hume's scepticism with regard to a priori judgments? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does... respond" - locate the exact point of disagreement
Core issue	What Kant concedes to Hume and what he denies
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the fork, the concession, the Second Analogy, the size of the victory
Ideal thesis	Kant accepts Hume's analysis of experience and denies his conclusion by relocating necessity
Non-negotiables	The missing third time; the concession; entitlement versus particular laws

Independent model answer

Hume's position. Enquiry divides into relations of ideas, known a priori and trivially, and matters of fact, known only from experience. No impression of necessary connexion is found, so causal necessity is a felt determination of the mind - custom, not reason.

Kant's concession. FACT: Kant grants Hume's analysis of *experience* entirely: no observed regularity yields necessity, and there is no impression of causal power. The dispute is not about impressions.

Kant's denial. The fork is **not exhaustive**. "Every event has a cause" is ampliative and yet necessary. The response is a change of standpoint: if objects, as objects of possible experience, conform to our forms, then what those forms contribute holds necessarily of every appearance.

The mechanism. In the Second Analogy, time itself cannot be perceived, and apprehension is successive whether I survey a house or watch a ship drift. The difference between subjective sequence and objective event lies in the **necessity of the order**, which requires a rule - the concept of cause (A189).

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Kant wins the **entitlement** to the concept of cause; he does not deliver particular causal connections, which remain empirical. Causality is valid of appearances only, so the same argument forbids inferring a first cause.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q1(b): name the concession explicitly. A script that presents Kant as refuting Hume's account of impressions has misidentified the disagreement.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: Hume in four lines; concession in two; denial in three; mechanism in four; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** Hume -> concession -> denial -> mechanism -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the fork; synthetic a priori; the Second Analogy.
- **Evidence:** the house and the ship; A189.
- **Distinction:** entitlement versus particular causal laws.
- **Criticism:** the closing restriction to appearances is the assessment.

2024 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Kant's objections against the ontological argument for the existence of God.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	" Critically examine" - the assessment limb is compulsory
Core issue	The objections, their reach, and what survives them
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the objection, the corollary, the dependency chain, the modern assessment
Ideal thesis	Devastating against the Cartesian and Anselmian forms; contested against modal reconstructions
Non-negotiables	"Real predicate" glossed; the contradiction corollary; Malcolm and Plantinga; the quantifier point

Independent model answer

The objections. First and principally: "being is obviously not a real predicate" (A598/B626). ANALYSIS: *Real* means **content-adding**, a determination that enlarges a concept. Existence does not enlarge a concept; it **posits** its object as actual. A hundred real thalers contain not the least coin more than a hundred possible thalers.

Second, the corollary about contradiction. The argument requires that denying God's existence be self-contradictory. But if subject and predicate are rejected together, nothing remains to conflict. Contradiction arises only when a subject is retained and one of its genuine predicates denied.

Third, the structural objection. Because the cosmological proof must identify its necessary being with the most real being, and the physico-theological proof must borrow an infinite cause, **all three proofs terminate in the ontological argument** - so one refutation is sufficient for all.

Critical assessment. The objection is widely judged **devastating** against the Cartesian and Anselmian formulations, and it changed the shape of the debate permanently. CAUTION: It is contested whether it reaches **modal** versions: Malcolm and Plantinga argue that treating *necessary existence*, rather than bare existence, as the relevant predicate escapes Kant's diagnosis, and the reply is that necessary existence may be a modal operator rather than a determination.

A further consideration strengthens Kant. If existence is not a predicate, what is it? His answer - that it is positing - was later formalised in the logic of the existential quantifier, so his objection is generally judged **vindicated** rather than superseded.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Decisive against the classical form; unsettled against its modal descendants - and in neither case a proof that God does not exist.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q2(c): the word "critically" makes the modal debate compulsory. Refuting and stopping forfeits the assessment mark.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: three objections in nine lines; assessment in five; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** three objections -> assessment -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** positing versus determining; the dependency chain.
- **Evidence:** A598/B626; the thalers; Malcolm and Plantinga.
- **Distinction:** classical versus modal formulations.
- **Criticism:** the quantifier vindication is the strongest available close.

Six original questions in the UPSC idiom - two at 10 marks, two at 15 and two at 20 - with complete model answers inside the declared bands. These are learner practice, not past papers.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between the transcendental and the transcendent in Kant, and explain why the distinction is indispensable to the Transcendental Dialectic. Discuss.

Independent model answer

The distinction. *Transcendental* names an enquiry into the a priori **conditions** under which objects can be given to us. It is legitimate and unavoidable; the deduction of the categories and the unity of apperception are transcendental. *Transcendent* names the employment of concepts **beyond** all possible experience. It is illegitimate, because a category has objective sense only through its schema, and a schema is a determination of time.

Why the Dialectic requires it. Reason's principle - that for every conditioned the whole series of conditions is given - is a **regulative** maxim directing enquiry toward systematic unity. Read constitutively, it becomes a claim about an existing unconditioned object, and the enquiry becomes transcendent.

Each of the three collapses is then a specific transcendent move. The Paralogisms convert a formal condition of thought into a soul-substance. The Antinomies treat the world-series as a given whole. The Ideal hypostatizes a standard of complete determination into an existing most real being.

ANALYSIS: **Kant's distinctive claim.** Transcendental illusion is **natural and unavoidable**, unlike a logical mistake that vanishes once exposed. Criticism prevents us from being deceived; it does not make the appearance disappear.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Without the distinction the Dialectic has no diagnosis - only a list of failed proofs.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Explain Kant's doctrine of the schematism and state precisely why the schemata must be determinations of time. Discuss.

Independent model answer

The problem. Subsumption normally requires **homogeneity**: the concept *plate* and a round dish share roundness. But categories are pure and intellectual while appearances are sensible, so they are **heterogeneous**. The Deduction proved that categories must apply; it did not show how.

The solution. A **third thing** (*ein Drittes*) is required - intellectual in one respect, sensible in another. That is the **transcendental schema**, produced by the productive imagination, and every schema is a **determination of time**.

Why time. The mediator must be universal and a priori, like the category, and contained in every appearance, like intuition. Time alone satisfies both: it is a pure a priori form and the form of **inner** sense, so every representation is in time. Space fails that test.

Schema, not image. Any drawn triangle is determinately scalene or equilateral; the schema is the **rule** for constructing a triangle in general.

Consequence. Without its schema a category is a mere logical function: it can be **thought** but determines no object - which is why the negative noumenon is thinkable.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Kant calls the procedure "an art concealed in the depths of the human soul" (A141/B180-1): the joint that carries the system is the one he cannot display.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: "The Second Analogy defeats Hume at the level of entitlement but not at the level of knowledge." Examine this claim.

Independent model answer

The claim's first half. Hume argued that no impression of necessary connexion is available, so the concept of cause is a product of custom. Kant grants the analysis and denies the conclusion. His master premise is that **time itself cannot be perceived** (A176/B219), so objective temporal relations must be established by rules found among appearances.

The argument runs: apprehension is successive in every case; I nevertheless distinguish surveying a house, where the order is **reversible** and mine to choose, from watching a ship drift downstream, where it is **irreversible**. That difference cannot lie in succession itself, nor be read off unperceivable time; it lies in the **necessity** of the order, which requires a rule - "everything that happens presupposes something upon which it follows according to a rule" (A189). The concept of cause is therefore a condition of experiencing an objective event.

The claim's second half. Kant never derives which causes operate. That bread nourishes, that this collision produces that motion, remain empirical discoveries. The Analogy secures the **form** of nature and leaves the **content** to science.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The claim is accurate. Kant wins the entitlement Hume denied and declines the knowledge Hume demanded - which is not an evasion but a consequence of separating form from content. CAUTION: Strawson calls the central transition a "non-sequitur of numbing grossness", since that the order of my perceptions is not up to me does not entail that the event is necessitated by a causal law; Guyer argues that at most *some* rule is required. Allison replies that Kant is describing the conditions under which a succession can be **judged** objective, and that only a causal rule can fix an irreversible position in one time. The restriction to appearances then follows: the same argument that defeats Hume forbids inferring a first cause of the world.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Assess the view that Kant's phenomena-noumena distinction is an empty boundary that his own system cannot sustain.

Independent model answer

The charge. Two objections combine. **Hegel** argues that the unknowable in-itself is an empty abstraction produced by fixing a permanent opposition between appearance and reality. **Jacobi** presses the affection problem: "without the assumption of things in themselves I cannot enter the system; with it I cannot remain" - for if causality is a category valid only of appearances, Kant cannot say that things in themselves cause our sensations.

The reply. Kant's noumenon in the **negative** sense is a *limiting concept* (*Grenzbegriff*): something considered merely as **not** an object of our sensible intuition. Its emptiness is deliberate, since a boundary that had content would no

longer be a boundary. A noumenon in the **positive** sense would require intellectual intuition, which Kant expressly denies we possess. The Schematism supplies the ground: a category without a schema can be **thought** but determines no object, which is exactly what "thinkable but not knowable" means.

Against Hegel, the distinction is therefore not a knowledge-claim about a hidden object; against Jacobi, Kant's language is more careful than the objection allows - he speaks of what **affects** sensibility without claiming theoretical cognition of a noumenal cause.

What survives the reply. CAUTION: The affection problem is a genuine tension, not a misreading. The **two-aspect** reading, on which the same objects are considered under two epistemic standpoints, reduces the pressure by making affection an aspect of one cognitive relation rather than a transaction between worlds; but the textual dispute with the two-world reading remains live.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The boundary is not empty in the pejorative sense: it does indispensable work, licensing the Principles for everything that can appear and forbidding their extension to soul, world and God. It is, however, a boundary Kant can state more securely than he can explain - and that is the honest formulation.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Kant's Transcendental Deduction is the strongest anti-sceptical argument in modern philosophy and rests on its weakest scaffolding." Critically examine.

Independent model answer

The strength. The Deduction asks the sceptic to concede almost nothing: that his representations are **his**. Kant's premise is that "the *I think* must be able to accompany all my representations" (B131-2); otherwise something would be represented in me that could not be thought, and would be nothing for me.

From that premise: combination "can never come to us through the senses", since sensibility is receptive and delivers a manifold but never its unity; every synthesis is an act of spontaneity. A manifold can belong to **one** consciousness only if combined in a determinate, repeatable way - that is, according to rules. Those rules are the categories, since a category just is the concept of a synthesis in accordance with a logical function of judgement. And an object is "that in the concept of which the manifold of a given intuition is united". Hence the categories are necessarily valid of every object of possible experience.

This is anti-scepticism without a premise the sceptic can refuse. It simultaneously answers Hume, who sought the self among impressions and found none because the "I think" is a condition and not a content, and rational psychology, which converted the same formal unity into a substance.

The weakness. The **metaphysical** deduction supplies the inventory: twelve categories read off twelve logical functions of judgement, on the premise that the understanding is a faculty of judging. Fichte, Hegel and later Kantians object that the derivation is artificial and the completeness claim rests entirely on the logic Kant inherited. Kant's defence - that the table of judgements is exhaustive and systematic, and that no more complete rival was offered - is a defence of the best available list, not a proof.

Adjudication. ANALYSIS: The two are separable. The Deduction's **strategy** is that objectivity is a *condition* rather than a *discovery*; its **inventory** is a historical contingency. Strawson's austere reading detaches the strategy and preserves the result. CAUTION: There is a further dispute - whether the A and B versions argue differently or only differ in exposition - but it concerns route and emphasis rather than the core claim.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The statement is accurate as it stands. The argument survives the loss of the table; the table would not survive the loss of the argument. Its remaining cost is scope: the conclusion holds of objects **as they can be given to us**, so the Deduction secures objectivity within possible experience and leaves things in themselves untouched.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Examine Kant's claim that all three speculative proofs for the existence of God fail together, and assess what his critique leaves standing.

Independent model answer

The structural claim. God, as the most real being (*ens realissimum*), lies beyond possible experience, and the categories have objective employment only through their schemata and hence only within experience. Kant then adds an exhaustiveness claim: there are only **three** speculative routes - from the mere concept (ontological), from the existence of anything at all (cosmological), and from the determinate order of nature (physico-theological).

Ontological. "Being is obviously not a real predicate" (A598/B626), where *real* means content-adding. Existence does not enlarge a concept; it **posits** its object as actual - a hundred real thalers contain not the least coin more than a hundred possible thalers. Nor is denying God's existence self-contradictory: if subject and predicate are rejected together, nothing remains to conflict.

Cosmological. Two blows. It misapplies **causality** beyond possible experience, since the totality of existents is not an event in time and the schema of cause is succession according to a rule *in* time. More decisively, identifying the necessary being with the most real being presupposes that the concept of the most real being includes necessary existence - which **is** the ontological argument. Kant calls the proof a "nest of dialectical assumptions".

Physico-theological. FACT: Kant treats it with respect as the oldest and clearest proof. But a finite effect licenses only a proportionate cause: at best an **architect** who orders pre-existing material, not a creator. To reach an infinite creator it must borrow an infinite or necessary cause - the cosmological proof - which in turn presupposes the ontological.

The chain. Design -> cosmological -> ontological -> fails. One refutation, three casualties.

What survives. Theoretical reason can neither prove nor disprove God: Kant is **agnostic, not atheistic**. Practical reason then **postulates** God, since the highest good requires a being able to proportion happiness to virtue - "I had to deny knowledge in order to make room for faith" (Bxxx; *Glaube* is rendered "belief" by Guyer-Wood). ANALYSIS: Freedom and immortality are postulated on parallel grounds, and the argument stops there: Kantian ethics as a doctrine is not printed in this syllabus item.

Verdict. CAUTION: The critique is decisive against the classical formulations and contested against modal reconstructions by Malcolm and Plantinga. What Kant leaves standing is not a diminished theology but a **relocated** one: God ceases to be an object of proof and becomes a condition of the moral life - at the price of conceding that theology can never be a science.